6.3.3 Methods to detect Food Adulteration

There are two methods to detect food adulterants. They are

1. Physical test

2. Laboratory chemical test

1. Physical test

It is conducted by observation or visual examination using our senses like taste, smell, and vision and also using lactometer.

2. Laboratory chemical test

Swaminathan.M has devised an instructional manual to detect food adulterant harmful effects on health is given below.

Table 6.2 Food Adulterants and its harmful effects.

S.No.	Food group	Adulterant	Harmful effects on health
1.	Cereals, wheat and other food grains	Ergot	Nausea, vomiting, Gastric pain burning sensation in extremities
2.	Pulses and legumes Dhal	Kesari Dhal and toxic dyes	Leads to lathryism.
3.	Milk and milk products Milk, Khoa, Bura cheese	Starch	Diarrhoea and vomiting
4.	Sugar and Jaggery	Washing soda	Diarrhoea, vomiting
	Honey	Invert sugar	Nausea, vomiting
	Jaggery	Washing soda Chalk powder	Diarrhoea, vomiting
5.	Edible oils and fats	Argemone oil Mineral oil Karanja oil Castor oil	Gastric problems, carcinogenic, skin problems
	Ghee & butter	Vanaspati Mashed potatoes and starches	Flatulence, gastric problems
6.	Spices & condiments Turmeric powder	Yellow aniline dyes. Non permitted colorants like metanil yellow	Causes giddiness, weakness, cyanosis, vomiting and are carcinogenic
	Chilli powder	Brick powder	Leads to gastric pain, cholic pain and indigestion

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